Types of Professional and Academic Texts

RA4: Valora documentos e informes, propios del sector o de la vida académica y cotidiana, relacionando los recursos lingüísticos con su propósito.

For each text type, you must understand its purpose, identify its register, and recognise the linguistic resources used.

1. Professional Emails

Professional emails are used to communicate formally in workplace contexts. Their purpose may be to inform, request, confirm, apologise or provide updates. They follow a clear structure: subject line, greeting, body, closing and signature.

Example:
Subject: Update on Database Migration Project

Dear Mr Thompson,

I am writing to provide an update on the database migration project. The initial testing phase has been successfully completed; however, a minor compatibility issue was identified during system integration.

Our technical team is currently working on resolving the issue, and we expect the system to be fully operational by the end of the week. We apologise for any inconvenience this delay may cause.

Kind regards,
Laura García

Analysis:
- Purpose: Inform and maintain professional communication.
- Register: Formal.
- Linguistic resources: Formal expressions, modal verbs, polite structures, clear organisation.

2. Technical Reports

Technical reports describe, analyse or evaluate technical processes or systems. They are structured into sections such as introduction, methodology, results and conclusion.

Example:
Introduction:

This report evaluates the performance of the new cybersecurity system.

Methodology:
The system was tested under simulated attack conditions. Multiple penetration tests were conducted.

Results:
The data indicates effective prevention of unauthorised access in 95% of cases.

Conclusion:
It is recommended that additional monitoring tools be implemented.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Evaluate performance.
- Register: Formal and objective.
- Linguistic resources: Passive voice, technical vocabulary, recommendation structures.

3. Project Documentation

Project documentation explains objectives, scope, resources and timeline.

Example:
Project Objective: Develop a mobile application for task management.
Scope: Users can create, edit and delete tasks.
Timeline: Development will be completed within eight weeks.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Organise and describe project planning.
- Register: Formal and structured.
- Linguistic resources: Future forms, technical vocabulary, section headings.

4. User Manuals and Instructions

User manuals provide step-by-step instructions using imperative forms.

Example:
1. Download the application.
2. Open the installation file.
3. Follow the on-screen instructions.
4. Restart the device.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Give instructions.
- Register: Neutral and instructional.
- Linguistic resources: Imperative verbs, conditional forms.

5. Incident Reports

Incident reports describe unexpected events factually.

Example:
Date: 12 March 2026
Description: The server stopped responding during peak hours.
Action Taken: The system was rebooted and normal operation was restored.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Describe incident and action taken.
- Register: Objective.
- Linguistic resources: Past tense, passive voice, time references.

6. Academic Articles or Summaries

Academic texts explain or analyse topics formally using connectors.

Example:
Artificial intelligence is transforming industries. In addition, it improves efficiency. However, ethical considerations must be addressed.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Explain and evaluate a topic.
- Register: Formal and academic.
- Linguistic resources: Connectors, formal vocabulary.

7. Job Offers and CVs

Job offers describe requirements; CVs summarise education and skills.

Example Job Offer:
We are seeking a junior developer with knowledge of Python. The candidate must work in a team.

Example CV Extract:
Education: Higher Vocational Training in Web Development.
Skills: Java, SQL, HTML.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Inform about employment / present profile.
- Register: Formal and concise.
- Linguistic resources: Modal verbs, concise bullet style.

8. Internal Notices

Internal notices communicate information within an organisation.

Example:
Notice: System Maintenance
The internal network will be unavailable on Friday from 18:00 to 21:00 due to scheduled maintenance.

Analysis:
- Purpose: Inform staff.
- Register: Formal and concise.
- Linguistic resources: Passive structures, formal tone.